

MYFIRSTBUSINESS.COM

Your First Business Plan

THE DIGITAL PRODUCT

Package something you know into a file, and sell the same file repeatedly at ~100% margin.

Generated 15 August 2026 · built for food & drink · free, and yours to keep

Educational content only. Not financial, legal or tax advice.

Your situation, stated honestly

A plan that ignores your constraints is fiction. Here is what you told us, written back to you as the boundary conditions everything else in this document had to fit inside.

Where you are	no idea yet
What you have in mind	nothing specific yet
The field	food and drink
What you have done for work	nothing yet
Capital you can risk	\$0
Time you can protect	under 5 hours a week
Financial pressure	income wanted within 3–6 months
Skills you already have	talking to people, organising
Where your customers are	online, anywhere
How you want to work	alone at a screen
Asking for money	nervous but willing
If you lost the money	small losses survivable
Winning in 12 months	\$500–\$1,000 a month on the side
What has stopped you	not knowing what step one is

Two of these matter more than the rest. Your capital sets which models are even available to you, and your available time sets how fast any of them can move. Everything that follows was filtered through those two numbers first — which is why this plan will look different from advice written for someone with money and a free calendar.

The business you should start

YOUR MATCH · 77/100

The Digital Product

Package something you know into a file, and sell the same file repeatedly at ~100% margin.

A template, guide, notion system, preset pack, or short course. The economics are perfect — build once, sell infinitely, no delivery cost. The catch is brutal and universally underestimated: making it is 10% of the work, distribution is the other 90%, and everyone gets this backwards.

IN ONE LINE

A Digital Product in food & drink, aimed at the one customer described below.

STARTING CAPITAL

\$0

FIRST DOLLAR IN

21 – 60 days

REALISTIC CEILING

\$1k–\$30k/mo depending entirely on distribution

Why this one, for you specifically

- You have no capital, and this model needs none.
- It is the shape that works in food and drink, where the money comes from food business customers who buy repeatedly.
- Your 3–6 month window is enough time for this to reach real revenue.
- It matches your preference for working alone at a screen.
- It can be run inside under 5 hours a week.

What it looks like in practice

- A spreadsheet system for a specific job role
- A set of templates for a specific tool
- A short, practical course on one narrow skill

Your two alternates

Take one of these if the primary does not appeal after a week — but not a fourth option. The cost of switching is the

ninety days you keep restarting.

02 The Teaching Business · 77/100

Get paid for what you already know, one person or one small group at a time.

Effectively tied — pick whichever you would enjoy more.

03 The Skill Service · 74/100

Sell one specific skill, done for one specific type of customer, for money, this month.

Effectively tied — pick whichever you would enjoy more.

Where your customers actually are

You said you have nothing specific in mind yet, which is the honest answer and not a problem. What follows is the shape of the opportunity in food & drink — read it as a starting position, not a verdict.

Who actually pays in this field

Busy people who want something better than they can make themselves, and small businesses that need feeding on a schedule — office lunches, event catering, market stalls, weekly meal drops.

Where you find them

Local Facebook groups and neighbourhood apps first, then a market stall or a pop-up outside somewhere with existing footfall. Offices within a mile of you are the most underrated buyer in this industry: they order repeatedly and pay on invoice.

YOUR FIRST WEEK, CONCRETELY

Cook one thing, extremely well, for ten people this week. Photograph it properly in daylight. One dish done outstandingly beats a menu of eight done adequately, and a menu is the most common way beginners in this industry stall for months.

What proof looks like here

Photos of real food you actually made, plus names of real people who ate it and said something specific.

The trap specific to this field

Building a menu before you have a customer. Every hour spent designing a menu is an hour not spent finding the ten people who will buy the one dish you already make best.

Before you take money — check this

Food is the most regulated industry on this list. Before you sell anything, look up your local food hygiene registration and home-kitchen rules — in most countries registration is free or near-free but legally required, and allergen labelling is not optional. This is the one place where "just start" is bad advice. Realistic cost to start here: \$0–\$60 for ingredients for a first batch. You do not need equipment yet.

Starting with a clean sheet

You said you have not worked yet. Worth stating plainly rather than treating as a gap, because it comes with two real advantages and one real cost, and knowing which is which changes what you do first.

What you already have

- Time, which is the one input most people trying to start a business genuinely do not have
- No expensive habits to protect and no salary to risk
- No ingrained assumptions about how an industry "has to" work

How it converts

You are starting without the two things that actually stop most people: sunk costs and a mortgage. The trade is that you have no credibility yet, so your entire early strategy is to manufacture proof fast — do the first jobs free, over-deliver visibly, and collect evidence. Three documented results and nobody will ask you about experience again.

YOUR UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

Nothing to unlearn, and nothing to lose.

Write that sentence down somewhere you will see it. When you are three weeks in and it feels like everyone else knows something you do not, the honest answer is that most of them are carrying assumptions you get to skip.

Your offer

Hormozi's Value Equation is the most practically useful formula in modern business, and it is the whole of offer design:

$$\text{Value} = (\text{Dream Outcome} \times \text{Perceived Likelihood of Achievement}) \div (\text{Time Delay} \times \text{Effort and Sacrifice})$$

You raise value by increasing the top two and decreasing the bottom two. That is the entire game, and it is why "lower my price" is almost never the right lever — price is not even in the equation.

The dream outcome you are selling

They skip the hundred hours you already spent figuring this out.

Their obstacles, converted into your solutions

Every objection is an obstacle you failed to remove in advance. Pre-handle them inside the offer instead of fighting them on the call.

THEIR OBSTACLE

YOUR BUILT-IN SOLUTION

They can't tell if it's any good before buying

Give away a real, usable slice of it publicly. The free slice is your advertisement

They've bought useless digital products before

Guarantee it unconditionally and make the promise narrow enough to be obviously deliverable

They can find something free on YouTube

True. You are selling organisation, sequence and time saved — not information. Price and position on that basis

Your risk reversal

Unconditional 30-day refund, stated loudly. Risk reversal is the cheapest conversion lever that exists and digital goods cost you nothing to refund.

What to charge on day one

Law 7: price is a strategic decision, not an arithmetic one. It signals quality, filters your customers, and funds your acquisition. A 1% price increase produces a bigger profit change than a 1% volume increase or a 1% cost cut, because it flows straight to the bottom line.

Value-based with a Good/Better/Best ladder. The middle tier is what most people buy; the top tier exists to make the middle look sensible.

TIER	WHAT THEY GET	STARTING PRICE
The thing	The core product on its own	\$27
Thing + support	Product plus templates, examples and a walkthrough	\$67
Thing + you	Product plus a live session or a review of their work	\$197

Under \$50 sells on impulse and needs volume. Over \$200 needs trust, which means you need an audience or a strong guarantee first. There is very little in between that works.

What this field specifically supports

Aim for food cost under 30% of your price. A \$12 lunch box should cost you under \$4 in ingredients. Catering is priced per head — \$15–\$40 is normal depending on the format. Cakes and bakes price at roughly 3–4× ingredient cost, minimum \$35 for anything custom.

Why three tiers and not one: price discrimination. Different customers have different willingness to pay, and a single price captures only one slice of the demand curve. The top tier does most of its work by making the middle tier look reasonable — most people buy the middle, which is the point.

How you get customers

Every lead on earth comes from one of four places: warm outreach (people who know you), cold outreach (people who don't), warm content (an audience you built), or cold content (paid advertising). Everything else is a variation. Choosing more than one at the start is the most common way beginners get nowhere on all of them.

YOUR CHANNEL

Warm content first, then cold content

Digital products have ~100% gross margin, which is the one thing that eventually makes paid ads viable. But not at the start — build organic distribution first, and only pay for traffic once you know your conversion rate.

Where your people are, in this field

Local Facebook groups and neighbourhood apps first, then a market stall or a pop-up outside somewhere with existing footfall. Offices within a mile of you are the most underrated buyer in this industry: they order repeatedly and pay on invoice.

Your required volume

Publish 3–5 times a week on one platform for the whole 90 days, every piece pointing at the free slice.

Law 5: volume negates luck. One attempt tells you nothing; a hundred tells you everything. Track every attempt in a spreadsheet from day one — contacts, replies, calls, closes. Without those four numbers you are guessing.

Use this, word for word, until you have your own data

The launch sequence that works:

1. Publish free content on the exact problem for 30 days
2. Say "I'm building the full version of this" — publicly, before it exists
3. Ask what should be in it. People who answer are your first buyers
4. Presell it at half price to that group before you build it
5. Build it. Ship it. Raise the price.

Do not "improve" this before you have sent it fifty times. Rewriting the script is the most popular way to avoid sending it.

Your 90-day plan

Scaled to the under 5 hours a week you said you can protect. It ends with money in your account, not with a finished logo. If you fall behind, do not restart — carry on from where you are.

Week one is the box in Section 03 — do that first, before anything below it.

Days 1–10 Find the question, don't invent the product

What do people repeatedly ask you, or ask in the forums where your people are? Build the answer to that, not the thing you find interesting.

Days 11–25 Presell before you build

Ten people paying \$15 up front is a validated product. Zero people is a saved month. This step is the entire risk management of this model.

Days 26–50 Build the smallest complete version

It has to solve the whole problem, not all problems. Complete and small beats comprehensive and unfinished.

Days 51–70 Distribution, not features

Every hour after launch goes to getting it in front of people, not to improving it. This is the step everyone skips.

Days 71–85 Collect proof

Ask every buyer for one specific sentence about what changed for them. Social proof compounds faster than any feature.

Days 86–90 Raise the price and add a tier

Add the "with support" version. Same product, more margin, more value for the people who want it.

The accountability loop that makes this work: every Saturday, three questions. What did I commit to last week? Did I do it — yes or no, no explanations? What is the one adjustment? Ten minutes. It is the difference between a plan and a habit.

The numbers you must know cold

Law 2: businesses die from lack of cash, not lack of profit. Law 8: if unit economics are broken, growing just makes you fail faster. Compute this before you spend a dollar on growth.

For your model specifically

- Revenue = traffic × conversion rate × price
- 2% conversion on a sales page is a normal, healthy result
- Gross margin ≈ 97% after payment processing
- Break-even is essentially the first sale — all the risk is your time

THE ONE TO WATCH

Traffic is the constraint, not the product. If you're not selling, you almost certainly have a distribution problem, not a quality problem.

The universal formulas

These apply to every business that has ever existed. Learn them from memory and you are ahead of most people who have read fifty business books.

METRIC	FORMULA
Gross margin	$(\text{Revenue} - \text{COGS}) \div \text{Revenue}$
Contribution margin	$\text{Price} - \text{variable cost per unit}$
Break-even units	$\text{Fixed costs} \div \text{contribution margin per unit}$
Customer acquisition cost	$\text{Total sales \& marketing spend} \div \text{new customers}$
Lifetime value	$\text{AOV} \times \text{gross margin \%} \times \text{frequency} \times \text{lifespan}$
LTV : CAC	Target ≥ 3:1. Below 3 is weak, above 5 you are underspending
Churn rate	$\text{Customers lost in period} \div \text{customers at start}$
Runway	$\text{Cash on hand} \div \text{monthly net burn}$

Your first ten customers

Not a strategy. A list of physical actions in order. Do them in this sequence.

1. Find the question that gets asked repeatedly
2. Presell to ten people before building anything
3. Build the smallest version that fully solves it
4. Give away 20% of it publicly, forever
5. Ask every buyer for one sentence of proof

The three traps that kill this model

These are not hypothetical. They are the specific, documented ways people fail at this exact business, and you will feel the pull of at least one of them.

- Building for three months before showing anyone. The single most common way this model fails.
- Making it comprehensive. Narrow and complete sells; broad and shallow doesn't.
- Assuming it will sell itself. Nothing sells itself. Ever.

And the trap specific to food & drink

Building a menu before you have a customer. Every hour spent designing a menu is an hour not spent finding the ten people who will buy the one dish you already make best.

Invert, always invert

Munger's tool, and the most reliable one in this document. When you are stuck, do not ask "how do I succeed at this?" Ask "what would guarantee that this fails?" — then refuse to do those things. The answer is almost always: stop sending messages, change the plan every week, and never ask anyone for money.

The thing that stopped you

"I don't know what step one is."

This is the most honest answer on the list, and the easiest for a document to actually solve, which is more or less why this site exists.

Paralysis at step one is almost never about the step. It is about the fact that step one has never been separated from steps two through fifty. When all fifty are in your head at once, the whole thing is unliftable. Separate them and each one is trivial.

The 90-day plan in this document is built as a sequence for exactly this reason. You do not need to believe in the whole plan or even understand it. You need to do the first block and then look at the second. That is all.

THIS WEEK

This week: do only the first line of the Days 1–7 block. Nothing else. Then come back and read the second line. Sequence beats motivation.

What to read, what to use

Your reading path — in this order

Not a library. Four books, sequenced for your model. Read one at a time, and after each one write a single page: three concepts, one application to a real business you can observe, one thing you disagree with. If you cannot write the page, you did not read the book.

- \$100M Offers — Alex Hormozi
- \$100M Leads — Alex Hormozi
- Breakthrough Advertising — Eugene Schwartz
- Obviously Awesome — April Dunford

Do not read them all before starting. Read the first one this week and begin the Days 1–7 block at the same time. Reading without reps is studying swim technique on a whiteboard.

Free tools that are genuinely enough

- Gumroad or Payhip — free to start, they take a cut
- Google Docs / Sheets / Canva — to build the thing
- Notion free — if it's a system or template
- Carrd free — a one-page sales page

Free learning worth the time

- Alex Hormozi's YouTube channel — largely the same material as the books, free
- Y Combinator Startup Library — dense, free, no fluff
- Acquired (podcast) — long-form histories of how real companies were actually built
- Aswath Damodaran (NYU) — full valuation and corporate finance courses, free
- Berkshire Hathaway shareholder letters, 1977 onward — the best business writing at any price
- SEC EDGAR — read three 10-Ks in your target industry and you will know more about its economics than most people working in it

The only number that predicts anything

Not books read. Not notes taken. Not plans made — including this one.

TRACK THIS

The number of times you have made an offer to a real human being and asked for money.

It is the only leading indicator that predicts whether any of this becomes a business. Print this page. Put a mark in a box every time you ask. Anything below fifty in ninety days means you were reading, not building.

Ninety days. Fill these in.

Sixty boxes. If you fill them, the business follows. That is not motivation, it is arithmetic — outcomes in business are heavy-tailed and probabilistic, and the person who takes ten times the shots gets ten times the lottery tickets.

Redo the questionnaire any time your situation changes — after your first customer, your answers on capital, skills and selling comfort will all be different, and the plan should change with them. myfirstbusiness.com is free, has no account, and nothing to cancel.